

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Manager and Product Owner for mission-critical technology.*

Positioning, 13 years owning backlogs and roadmaps in defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, and payments, across multi-stakeholder environments where scope decisions carry real consequence.

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§ WHY SPACE42

Space42 sits at the intersection of AI and national-critical infrastructure, which is where product management actually gets hard. The posting is explicit that this is a decision-making role with real authority over scope and sequencing, not a documentation function. That matches how I have worked at Rohde & Schwarz on the FCAS programme, where I owned backlog and roadmap decisions across a 15-person cross-functional team and needed to push back on senior stakeholders when sequencing conflicted with platform stability. The preference for government, defence, and aerospace experience is something I can walk straight into, not build toward. *That is the kind of environment where getting prioritisation right actually matters.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case analysis
- **GitHub Copilot**, assisted development and code review
- **Cursor**, AI-accelerated codebase navigation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, requirements drafting and stakeholder document prep
- **Gamma.app**, presentation and roadmap communication

- **Jira**, backlog management and sprint tracking
 - **Miro**, workshop facilitation and workflow mapping
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Scrum in Jira and Confluence, SAFe with agile release trains and PI planning.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers.

- Built zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, with LLM agents running the intake and qualification funnel.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL; one person runs the day-to-day through agent automation.
 - Demonstrates end-to-end product ownership, discovery, build, and operations, without an engineering team, which is relevant for a role managing multiple workstreams simultaneously.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT SPACE42

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the backlog refinement and sprint planning sessions across each active workstream, map the dependency graph between systems and integrations, and identify where sequencing decisions are being made by default rather than by choice.

WEEK 2

Clarify and sequence.

Work with engineering and architecture to surface the two or three backlog items where unclear scope or unresolved dependencies are most likely to create delivery risk, and draft a prioritisation proposal for stakeholder review.

WEEK 3+

Ship and hold the line.

Own the sprint cadence, run UAT coordination with customers, and start defending scope and sequencing decisions, including challenging requests that conflict with agreed priorities or system stability.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Specialist, Product Management role at Space42.

My background fits this posting closely. I have 13 years of product ownership in environments where the backlog is not a wish list and sequencing decisions carry real operational consequence. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the backlog and roadmap for the FCAS European programme, a multinational AI and data platform, managing 15 engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira. I pushed back on scope requests that would have destabilised a platform already serving production workloads, and I defended those calls to senior stakeholders across multiple organisations. Before that, at the Bundesagentur für Arbeit, I ran a national labour-market analytics platform as both Product Manager and Deputy IT Security Officer, which gave me direct exposure to security-conscious, structured environments where you cannot move fast and break things.

The posting describes a role with real authority over scope and sequencing, and the expectation that you will challenge or defer requests where required. That is how I have always worked. At CLINET Platforms I inherited a backlog a five-person team could not deliver, cut it to the top 10% of features against agreed success criteria, and user acceptance rose more than fivefold. At EMIL Group I restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads, which stopped the senior engineer attrition that was eroding client trust. Both situations required making and defending decisions that not everyone in the room wanted to hear.

Your preference for experience in government, defence, aerospace, or other mission-critical environments is something I can meet directly rather than approximate. The FCAS programme

and the Bundesdruckerei identity management platform for the Robert Koch Institute are both in that category. I also co-founded Qcrypt AG, an IT security company building quantum-secure encryption for enterprise and government buyers, I was Product Owner there for six years and later served as Chair of the board.

The AI-driven angle Space42 leads with is also where I work today. I use Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, and Lovable as daily tools for specification, prototyping, and edge-case analysis, and I have shipped agentic workflows in my own projects. I understand the difference between AI as a buzzword in a roadmap and AI as a shipping dependency in a live system.

I am open to relocating to Abu Dhabi and can be available on short notice.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of product ownership in defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance, healthcare, payments, and retail. I own backlogs and roadmaps across live production systems, translate customer and business needs into prioritised, engineering-ready scope, and lead cross-functional teams through Agile and Scrum delivery. I have worked in government, defence, and security-conscious environments where getting sequencing right carries real consequence.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
- On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
- Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
- I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.

§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update; integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and freed several QA hours every week.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the backlog to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system (KIS) workflows: the digital anamnesis went from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for new insurance product launches from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

- Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems. Moved research results into production in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

- Government, secure data platform. Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

- Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop. Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

- Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

- Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - PRESENT

- Construction staffing, two-sided B2B marketplace. Zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption for enterprise and government buyers. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes. Later Chair of the board.

CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO, SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES, BERLIN | 03/2018 - 08/2021

- Nanotechnology and agriculture. Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse, inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ SKILLS

Product Ownership: user stories, acceptance criteria, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, definition of done, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT (user acceptance testing), Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Product Management: product roadmap, prioritisation, continuous discovery, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Agile, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI planning.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor and Lovable.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, ETL.

Analytics and Data: KPI definition, funnel and churn analysis, MicroStrategy, Matomo, PostgreSQL, ETL, Dagster, dbt.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance and Compliance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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